Build an agent in Python: review

AI agents · Upper secondary · Unit check



In this unit

- Read a tool call
- Tools are functions
- The agent loop
- Guardrails in code

The big ideas

- The model writes text; your code reads it
- Tools are functions, reached through a dictionary
- A loop with a step limit, tested honestly
- Guardrails: allow-list, exact approval, checks, a log

Activity: Build the agent on paper

1. Warm-up (3 min): Name the four parts of your agent.
2. Draw (7 min): The whole agent as boxes and arrows.
3. Break it (7 min): A partner finds a call that gets through.
4. Fix (3 min): Add the rule that stops it.

Use made-up tools, places and people only.

Let's discuss

1. Which part of your agent was hardest to get right?
2. What could a real model do that your scripted model never did?
3. Where would you put a person in the loop, and why?

Exit ticket

- One guardrail I would add to every agent, and why.